Text 1

第 1 段

First two hours, now three hours —this is how far in advance authorities are recommending people show up to catch a domestic flight, at least at some major U.S. airports with increasingly massive security lines.

直译：先是两小时，现在是三小时——这是有关部门建议人们乘坐国内航班时提前到达机场的时间，至少在美国一些安检队伍越来越长的大型机场是如此。

第 2 段

Americans are willing to tolerate time-consuming security procedures in return for increased safety. The crash of EgyptAir Flight 804, which terrorists may have downed over the Mediterranean Sea, provides another tragic reminder of why. But demanding too much of air travelers or providing too little security in return undermines public support for the process. And it should: Wasted time is a drag on Americans' economic and private lives, not to mention infuriating.

直译：美国人愿意忍受耗时的安检程序，以换取更高的安全性。埃及航空八〇四号航班在地中海上空坠毁，可能是被恐怖分子击落的；这一事件再次以悲剧性的方式提醒人们，为什么需要安检。但是，对航空旅客要求过多，或者相应提供的安全保障过少，都会削弱公众对这一程序的支持。这样的反应也理所应当：浪费时间会拖累美国人的经济生活和私人生活，更不用说还会令人愤怒。

第 3 段

Last year, the Transportation Security Administration (TSA) found in a secret check that undercover investigators were able to sneak weapons —both fake and real —past airport security nearly every time they tried. Enhanced security measures since then, combined with a rise in airline travel due to the improving economy and low oil prices, have resulted in long waits at major airports such as Chicago's O'Hare International. It is not yet clear how much more effective airline security has become —but the lines are obvious.

直译：去年，美国运输安全管理局（TSA）在一次秘密检查中发现，卧底调查人员几乎每次尝试都能把武器——无论真假——偷偷带过机场安检。此后加强的安保措施，再加上经济改善和低油价带来的航空出行增长，使芝加哥奥黑尔国际机场等主要机场出现长时间等待。航空安检究竟变得多么有效，目前还不清楚，但排队长龙却明摆在那里。

第 4 段

Part of the issue is that the government did not anticipate the steep increase in airline travel, so the TSA is now rushing to get new screeners on the line. Part of the issue is that airports have only so much room for screening lanes. Another factor may be that more people are trying to overpack their carry-on bags to avoid checked-baggage fees, though the airlines strongly dispute this.

直译：问题的一部分在于，政府没有预料到航空出行量会急剧增长，因此 TSA 现在正急忙把新安检人员安排到岗位上。另一部分在于，机场能用于安检通道的空间就只有那么多。还有一个因素可能是，越来越多的人为了避开托运行李费，试图往随身行李里装入过多物品，尽管航空公司对此极力否认。

第 5 段

There is one step the TSA could take that would not require remodeling airports or rushing to hire: Enroll more people in the PreCheck program. PreCheck is supposed to be a win-win for travelers and the TSA. Passengers who pass a background check are eligible to use expedited screening lanes. This allows the TSA to focus on travelers who are higher risk, saving time for everyone involved. The TSA wants to enroll 25 million people in PreCheck. It has not gotten anywhere close to that, and one big reason is sticker shock: Passengers must pay $85 every five years to process their background checks. Since the beginning, this price tag has been PreCheck's fatal flaw. Upcoming reforms might bring the price to a more reasonable level. But Congress should look into doing so directly, by helping to finance PreCheck enrollment or to cut costs in other ways.

直译：TSA 可以采取一项既不需要改建机场、也不需要匆忙招人的措施：让更多人加入预检计划。预检计划本应让旅客和 TSA 双方获益。通过背景调查的旅客，有资格使用快速安检通道。这样 TSA 就能把注意力集中于风险较高的旅客，为所有相关人员节省时间。TSA 希望让两千五百万人加入预检计划，但实际人数远未接近这一目标，一个重要原因是高价令人望而却步：旅客每五年必须支付八十五美元，以办理背景调查。从一开始，这个价格就是预检计划的致命缺陷。即将进行的改革，或许能把价格降到更合理的水平。但是，国会应该研究如何直接实现这一点，例如资助预检注册，或者用其他方式降低费用。

第 6 段

The TSA cannot continue diverting resources into underused PreCheck lanes while most of the traveling public suffers in unnecessary lines. It is long past time to make the program work.

直译：当大多数出行公众在不必要的队伍中受苦时，TSA 不能继续把资源转移到使用不足的预检通道上。早就该让这一计划真正发挥作用了。

Text 2

第 1 段

"The ancient Hawaiians were astronomers," wrote Queen Liliuokalani, Hawaii's last reigning monarch, in 1897. Star watchers were among the most esteemed members of Hawaiian society. Sadly, all is not well with astronomy in Hawaii today. Protests have erupted over construction of the Thirty Meter Telescope (TMT), a giant observatory that promises to revolutionize humanity's view of the cosmos.

直译：夏威夷最后一位在位君主利留卡拉尼女王于一八九七年写道："古代夏威夷人是天文学家。"观星者曾是夏威夷社会最受尊敬的成员之一。遗憾的是，如今夏威夷的天文学状况并非一切顺利。围绕三十米望远镜（TMT）的建设，抗议已经爆发；这是一座巨型天文台，有望彻底改变人类对宇宙的认识。

第 2 段

At issue is the TMT's planned location on Mauna Kea, a dormant volcano worshiped by some Hawaiians as the piko, that connects the Hawaiian Islands to the heavens. But Mauna Kea is also home to some of the world's most powerful telescopes. Rested in the Pacific Ocean, Mauna Kea's peak rises above the bulk of our planet's dense atmosphere, where conditions allow telescopes to obtain images of unsurpassed clarity.

直译：争议的焦点，是 TMT 计划设在莫纳克亚山。那是一座休眠火山，一些夏威夷人将其奉为连接夏威夷群岛与天空的"脐带"。但莫纳克亚山也是世界上一些最强大望远镜的所在地。它坐落于太平洋之中，山峰高出地球大部分稠密大气层；那里的条件，使望远镜能够获取清晰度无与伦比的图像。

第 3 段

Opposition to telescopes on Mauna Kea is nothing new. A small but vocal group of Hawaiians and environmentalists have long viewed their presence as disrespect for sacred land and a painful reminder of the occupation of what was once a sovereign nation.

直译：反对在莫纳克亚山设置望远镜，并不是什么新鲜事。一小群人数不多却积极发声的夏威夷人和环保人士，长期把望远镜的存在视为对神圣土地的不敬，也把它们视为一种痛苦的提醒：这个曾经独立自主的国家遭到了占领。

第 4 段

Some blame for the current controversy belongs to astronomers. In their eagerness to build bigger telescopes, they forgot that science is not the only way of understanding the world. They did not always prioritize the protection of Mauna Kea's fragile ecosystems or its holiness to the island's inhabitants. Hawaiian culture is not a relic of the past; it is a living culture undergoing a renaissance today.

直译：天文学家应对当前争议承担一部分责任。他们急于建造更大的望远镜，却忘记了科学并不是理解世界的唯一方式。他们并非总是优先保护莫纳克亚山脆弱的生态系统，或优先尊重这座山对岛上居民而言具有的神圣性。夏威夷文化不是过去的遗迹；它是一种活着的文化，如今正经历复兴。

第 5 段

Yet science has a cultural history, too, with roots going back to the dawn of civilization. The same curiosity to find what lies beyond the horizon that first brought early Polynesians to Hawaii's shores inspires astronomers today to explore the heavens. Calls to disassemble all telescopes on Mauna Kea or to ban future development there ignore the reality that astronomy and Hawaiian culture both seek to answer big questions about who we are, where we come from and where we are going. Perhaps that is why we explore the starry skies, as if answering a primal calling to know ourselves and our true ancestral homes.

直译：然而，科学也有自身的文化历史，其根源可以追溯到文明的黎明。最初促使早期波利尼西亚人来到夏威夷海岸、想知道地平线之外有什么的那份好奇心，如今也激励着天文学家探索天空。要求拆除莫纳克亚山上所有望远镜，或禁止未来在此开发的呼声，忽视了一个事实：天文学与夏威夷文化都在寻求回答有关我们是谁、我们来自哪里、我们将走向何方这些重大问题。也许这正是我们探索星空的原因，仿佛是在回应一种原初的召唤，去认识自己以及真正的祖先家园。

第 6 段

The astronomy community is making compromises to change its use of Mauna Kea. The TMT site was chosen to minimize the telescope's visibility around the island and to avoid archaeological and environmental impact. To limit the number of telescopes on Mauna Kea, old ones will be removed at the end of their lifetimes and their sites returned to a natural state. There is no reason why everyone cannot be welcomed on Mauna Kea to embrace their cultural heritage and to study the stars.

直译：天文学界正在作出妥协，改变其使用莫纳克亚山的方式。TMT 的选址，是为了尽可能降低从岛上各处看见望远镜的程度，并避免对考古遗址和环境造成影响。为了限制莫纳克亚山上的望远镜数量，老旧望远镜将在使用寿命结束时被拆除，其原址将恢复自然状态。没有理由不能欢迎所有人来到莫纳克亚山，珍视自己的文化遗产，并研究群星。

Text 3

第 1 段

Robert F. Kennedy once said that a country's GDP measures "everything except that which makes life worthwhile." With Britain voting to leave the European Union, and GDP already predicted to slow as a result, it is now a timely moment to assess what he was referring to.

直译：罗伯特 · F. 肯尼迪曾说，一个国家的国内生产总值（GDP）衡量了 " 一切，却唯独没有衡量那些使生命值得度过的事物 "。随着英国投票决定退出欧盟，而且人们已经预测 GDP 增长会因此放缓，现在正是评估他所指为何的恰当时机。

第 2 段

The question of GDP and its usefulness has annoyed policymakers for over half a century. Many argue that it is a flawed concept. It measures things that do not matter and misses things that do. By most recent measures, the UK's GDP has been the envy of the Western world, with record low unemployment and high growth figures. If everything was going so well, then why did over 17 million people vote for Brexit, despite the warnings about what it could do to their country's economic prospects?

直译：半个多世纪以来，GDP 及其效用的问题一直困扰着政策制定者。许多人认为，这是一个有缺陷的概念。它衡量无关紧要的事物，却遗漏真正重要的事物。按照最新的多数指标，英国的 GDP 表现曾令西方世界羡慕：失业率创下新低，增长数字也很高。如果一切都如此顺利，那么为什么有超过一千七百万人投票支持脱欧，尽管此前已有警告，指出这可能给他们国家的经济前景带来怎样的影响?

第 3 段

A recent annual study of countries and their ability to convert growth into well-being sheds some light on that question. Across the 163 countries measured, the UK is one of the poorest performers in ensuring that economic growth is translated into meaningful improvements for its citizens. Rather than just focusing on GDP, over 40 different sets of criteria from health, education and civil society engagement have been measured to get a more rounded assessment of how countries are performing.

直译：最近一项关于各国及其把增长转化为福祉能力的年度研究，为这个问题提供了一些解释。在接受衡量的一百六十三个国家中，就确保经济增长转化为公民生活的实质改善而言，英国是表现最差的国家之一。该研究没有只关注 GDP，而是衡量了来自健康、教育和公民社会参与等领域的四十多组不同标准，以便更全面地评估各国的表现。

第 4 段

While all of these countries face their own challenges, there are a number of consistent themes. Yes, there has been a budding economic recovery since the 2008 global crash, but in key indicators in areas such as health and education, major economies have continued to decline. Yet this isn't the case with all countries. Some relatively poor European countries have seen huge improvements across measures including civil society, income equality and the environment.

直译：尽管这些国家都面临各自的挑战，但仍存在一些共同主题。是的，自二〇〇八年全球经济崩溃以来，经济复苏已经开始萌芽，但在健康、教育等领域的关键指标上，主要经济体仍持续下滑。然而，并非所有国家都是如此。一些相对贫穷的欧洲国家，在公民社会、收入平等和环境等多项指标上都取得了巨大进步。

第 5 段

This is a lesson that rich countries can learn: When GDP is no longer regarded as the sole measure of a country's success, the world looks very different.

直译：这是富裕国家可以学习的一课：当 GDP 不再被视为衡量一个国家成功与否的唯一尺度时，世界看起来就大不相同。

第 6 段

So, what Kennedy was referring to was that while GDP has been the most common method for measuring the economic activity of nations, as a measure, it is no longer enough. It does not include important factors such as environmental quality or education outcomes - all things that contribute to a person's sense of well-being.

直译：因此，肯尼迪所指的是：虽然 GDP 一直是衡量各国经济活动最常用的方法，但作为一种衡量尺度，它已不再足够。它没有包括环境质量或教育成果等重要因素，而这些都会增进一个人的幸福感。

第 7 段

The sharp hit to growth predicted around the world and in the UK could lead to a decline in the everyday services we depend on for our well-being and for growth. But policymakers who refocus efforts on improving well-being rather than simply worrying about GDP figures could avoid the forecasted doom and may even see progress.

直译：人们预测，全球和英国的经济增长将遭受沉重打击，这可能导致我们为获得福祉和增长而依赖的日常服务水平下降。但是，如果政策制定者重新把努力集中于改善福祉，而不是仅仅担忧 GDP 数字，他们就可能避开预言中的厄运，甚至可能看到进步。

Text 4

第 1 段

In a rare unanimous ruling, the US Supreme Court has overturned the corruption conviction of a former Virginia governor, Robert McDonnell. But it did so while holding its nose at the ethics of his conduct, which included accepting gifts such as a Rolex watch and a Ferrari automobile from a company seeking access to government.

直译：美国最高法院在一次罕见的一致裁决中，推翻了对弗吉尼亚州前州长罗伯特·麦克唐纳的腐败定罪。但法院在这样做的同时，对其行为的道德性深感厌恶；他的行为包括接受一家企图接近政府的公司赠送的劳力士手表和法拉利汽车等礼物。

第 2 段

The high court's decision said the judge in Mr. McDonnell's trial failed to tell a jury that it must look only at his "official acts," or the former governor's decisions on "specific" and "unsettled" issues related to his duties.

直译：最高法院的裁决指出，在麦克唐纳先生的审判中，法官没有告诉陪审团，它必须仅考察他的“公务行为”，也就是这位前州长针对与职责相关的“具体”且“尚未解决”的问题所作的决定。

第 3 段

Merely helping a gift-giver gain access to other officials, unless done with clear intent to pressure those officials, is not corruption, the justices found.

直译：大法官们认定，仅仅帮助送礼者接触其他官员，并不构成腐败，除非这样做时具有向那些官员施压的明确意图。

第 4 段

The court did suggest that accepting favors in return for opening doors is "distasteful" and "nasty." But under anti-bribery laws, proof must be made of concrete benefits, such as approval of a contract or regulation. Simply arranging a meeting, making a phone call, or hosting an event is not an "official act".

直译：法院确实表示，接受好处以换取替人打开方便之门，是“令人反感的”和“恶劣的”。但是，根据反贿赂法律，必须证明存在具体利益，例如批准合同或法规。仅仅安排会面、打一个电话或主办活动，并不构成“公务行为”。

第 5 段

The court's ruling is legally sound in defining a kind of favoritism that is not criminal. Elected leaders must be allowed to help supporters deal with bureaucratic problems without fear of prosecution for bribery. "The basic compact underlying representative government," wrote Chief Justice John Roberts for the court, "assumes that public officials will hear from their constituents and act on their concerns."

直译：法院通过界定一种不属于犯罪的偏袒行为，在法律上作出了合理裁决。必须允许民选领导人帮助支持者处理官僚程序中的问题，而不必担心因此被以贿赂罪起诉。首席大法官约翰·罗伯茨代表法院写道：“代议制政府赖以成立的基本契约，假定公职人员会听取其选民的意见，并就选民关心的事项采取行动。”

第 6 段

But the ruling reinforces the need for citizens and their elected representatives, not the courts, to ensure equality of access to government. Officials must not be allowed to play favorites in providing information or in arranging meetings simply because an individual or group provides a campaign donation or a personal gift. This type of integrity requires well-enforced laws in government transparency, such as records of official meetings, rules on lobbying, and information about each elected leader's source of wealth.

直译：但是，这项裁决更加凸显了一种必要性：确保人们平等接近政府，应当由公民及其民选代表来实现，而不是由法院来实现。不能仅因为某个个人或团体提供了竞选捐款或私人礼物，就允许官员在提供信息或安排会面时偏袒他们。维护这种廉正，需要有关政府透明度的法律得到切实执行，例如公务会面记录、游说规则，以及有关每位民选领导人财富来源的信息。

第 7 段

Favoritism in official access can fan public perceptions of corruption. But it is not always corruption. Rather officials must avoid double standards, or different types of access for average people and the wealthy. If connections can be bought, a basic premise of democratic society —that all are equal in treatment by government —is undermined. Good governance rests on an understanding of the inherent worth of each individual.

直译：在接触官员方面的偏袒，会助长公众对腐败的感受。但这并不总是腐败。更确切地说，官员必须避免双重标准，避免让普通人和富人以不同方式接近政府。如果关系可以用钱买到，民主社会的一项基本前提——所有人都受到政府平等对待——就会遭到破坏。良好治理建立在对每个人固有价值的理解之上。

第 8 段

The court's ruling is a step forward in the struggle against both corruption and official favoritism.

直译：法院的裁决，是在反对腐败和官员偏袒的斗争中向前迈出的一步。